use force to defend itself against unprovoked attack from outside. Of course the State should allow an absolutely peaceful and friendly policy to its neighbour and other States, but nevertheless it is absurd to deny the possibility of attack. The State will also have to pass some laws of a coercive nature, in the sense that they take away some rights and privileges from various classes and groups and restrict liberty of action. All laws are to some extent coercive. The Karachi programme of the Congress lays down that "In order to end the exploitation of the masses, political freedom must include real economic freedom of the starving millions." To give effect to this desirable sentiment the over-privileged will have to give up much to the under-privileged. Further, it is laid down that workers must have a living wage and various other amenities; that special taxes will be charged on property; that "the State shall own or control key industries and services, mineral resources, railways, waterways, shipping and other means of public transport." Also that "intoxicating drinks and drugs shall be totally prohibited." All this is likely to be objected to by considerable numbers of people. They may submit to the will of the majority, but that will be because they are afraid of the consequences of disobedience. Democracy indeed means the coercion of the minority by the majority.

If a law affecting property rights or abolishing them to a large extent is passed by a majority, is that to be objected to because it is coercion? Manifestly not, because the same procedure is followed in the adoption of all democratic laws. Objection, therefore, cannot be taken on the ground of coercion. It might be said that the majority was acting wrongly or immorally. The question to be considered then is: whether the law as passed by a majority offended any ethical principle. Who is to decide this? If individuals and groups are allowed to interpret ethics in accordance with their own interests, there is an end of democratic procedure. Personally I feel that the institution of private property (except in a very restricted sense) gives dangerous power to individuals over society as a whole, and is therefore very harmful to society. I consider it immoral, far more so than drink, which harms the individual more than society.

I have been told, however, by some people who claim to believe in the doctrine of non-violence that to attempt to nationalise private property, except with the consent of the owners thereof, would be coercion, and as such opposed to non-violence. Indeed this view-point has been impressed upon me by big zamindars, who do not scruple to take the aid of the State in forcibly collecting their rents; and capitalists, owning many factories,